

1949, February 7

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX PRIARY

HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

February 7th, 1949

Miss Mae C Berling
Decater, Indiana

God Bless you Miss Berling - you and yours:

I hope this finds you well, which means of course hopeful too. This latter is something that is sadly overlooked, to the great detriment of spiritual progress as well as physical.

The probably all-outstanding example or proof of this is the historical scandal that some of the disciples took at Jesus' choice of the CROSS AND CALVARY whereby to establish His Reign of love, rather than any other; - the scandal that drew from St. Peter himself: "Master! Far be it from thee...." and the alarming response: "Get thee behind me satan..... Thou savorst not of God".

It is well to remember that such scandal was never intended to be confined to the Apostolic-ages. Hence, Saint Bernard - the outstanding Doctor of the Middle-ages - wisely reminds: "Since the scandal of the Cross it is never reasonable to take scandal". Another occasion of the first disciples taking scandal is the detailed insistence of His giving us Himself for our own life of soul: "I am the bread of life. Your fathers did eat manna in the desert and are dead. This is the bread which cometh down from heaven; that if any man eat of it, he may not die". (Jno. VI, 48)

Of course it is only natural for honest, upright people to resent falsehood and injustice as was St. Peter in striking off the brutal Malchum's ear. The same can be said of the wave of international indignation that the damnable hypocrisy manifest these days in the sacrilegious treatment of Cardinal Josef Mindezenty.

Of course it is but natural for moral integrity to resent falsehood and injustice wherever accosted

(Unfinished draft)